



VR can be used by doctors to get training on how to operate a human body using a surgery simulator (video game)



Gaming console (Credit: <https://s12emagst.akamaized.net>)

ESRB, games that are designed for everyone are rated E, for those above ten years of age are rated E10+, for teens between ten to seventeen years of age are rated T, for those above seventeen years of age are rated M, and for eighteen years and above are rated as A.

If video games are played by the suitable age group, then these will most likely not cause any psychological problems. However, some video games are often played by unsuitable age groups by means of piracy or if the game is free to download, which could have a psychological effect on the users.

Video games can improve brain function

Even though video games could cause addiction, playing certain games can help improve the cognitive function of the brain. Children who play video games develop better cognitive skills and better learning abilities. A new research done by the researchers at Yale University, USA, found that children who play video games are always good at learning.

Your brain is yours. If you do not use it, you lose it! Many age-related brain disorders, like Alzheimer's disease, can progress in people who do not like doing brain work and live an easygoing life. One research shows that people who solve puzzles

and board games frequently are less likely to develop Alzheimer's disease. So, playing board games and puzzles on your PC or mobile can also help reduce the risk of brain-related disorders like Alzheimer's.

Moreover, when you play a game like chess on a PC, you are competing with a computer, and a computer is a completely logical machine. The more you play with a computer, the better your brain learns to become logical. However, defeating a computer is not easy and some might find it frustrating, but playing with a computer instead of a human helps a lot in improving thinking abilities. Because if the opponent player is a human, then he or she may not have better playing skills than you to compete with.

Apart from Alzheimer's disease, some video games might also cure mental disorders like ADHD. Games like Project: Evo and Akili have been designed to cure ADHD but are waiting for FDA's approval.

Video games are also good stress busters, and a new study of millennial gamers has revealed that video games can help reduce mental stress. Behavioral Science Institute in The Netherlands has found that some video games can help reduce mental stress. And a survey done by Luke Hales, GM of Dave TV Channel, has also concluded the same.

Future of video games

Due to the advent of new technologies, video gaming experience has gone to another level. Previously, video games were only played on game consoles but now people can also play on their smartphones. Apart from using gamepads and touch screens, a new technology called gesture control allows playing video games only with hand movements and gestures. This technology has made playing video games a lot easier, and it is also suitable for people of all age groups.

Virtual reality (VR) is another new technology that allows users to experience video games or any 3D simulator in a 3D environment with the help of VR headsets. In VR gaming, one can feel the presence in the gaming environment and visualise everything around, virtually. Apart from gaming, VR is also being used for simulation and training purposes.

Besides VR, there is another technology called brain computer interface (BCI), where a headset is used to communicate with the computer from the brain directly, using electrical signals. It can be used as a control device for video games, too.

As technology improves, video games will become increasingly enjoyable and useful in the future. Starting from game consoles to touch phones, video games are enjoyed by people of various age groups, and even though there are some psychological effects sometimes, playing them appropriately will not cause any problem. **END** 🐧

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The article was originally published in the February 2020 issue of Electronics For You.